

Games

Long before the Internet, computer games, and TV, people invented games. Board and card games have been around for hundreds or even thousands of years and are as challenging and fun to play today as they ever were.



CHINESE CHEQUERS

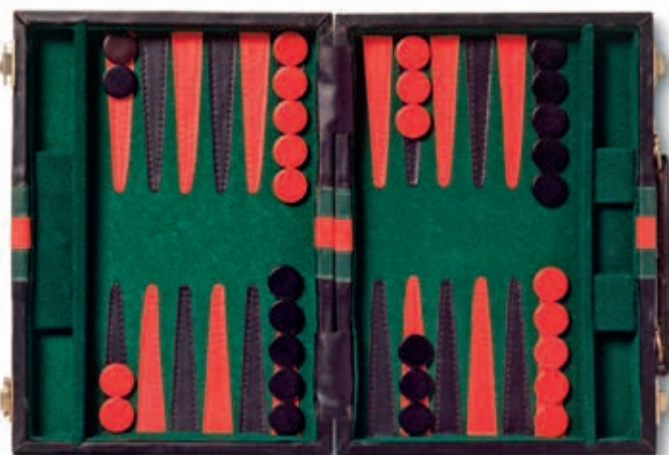
The aim of this game is to race your coloured pegs across the board to the opposite point of the star. You can move along one hole at a time or hop over pegs in your path.

TABLE-TOP GAMES

These competitive games have flat boards, small pieces, and can take hours of concentration before someone wins. Over the years, games like these became a focus for social get-togethers. They are still a great way to gather people round a table to have fun.

BACKGAMMON

This game for two players is one of the oldest in the world. It involves a mixture of strategy and luck as players roll dice and then decide how to move their counters. The winner is the first player to clear their pieces off the board.



SLAKES AND LADDERS

Players throw a die to move up the board and, hopefully, land on a ladder to skip rows. But watch out for the snakes!

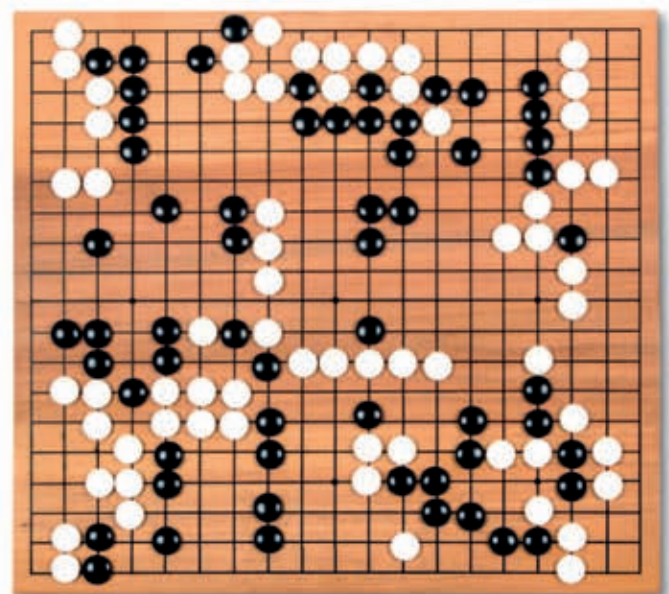
GO GAME

Go starts with an empty board. Players place their stones where the lines cross to build territories. Or they surround and capture enemy stones.



DRAUGHTS

The aim of this game is to grab all your opponent's pieces by jumping over them diagonally as you cross the board.



PLAYING PIECES

The earliest games were played with anything that came to hand — pebbles, shells, sticks, and bones. Nowadays, many games have written rules, boards, tiles, counters, marbles, or pegs.

MANCALA

There are hundreds of different versions of mancala. Players move seeds or stones along pits on the board and try to collect the largest store.



MAHJONG

In this ancient Chinese game, four players take turns to pick up and discard tiles. The aim is to collect sets of different types.

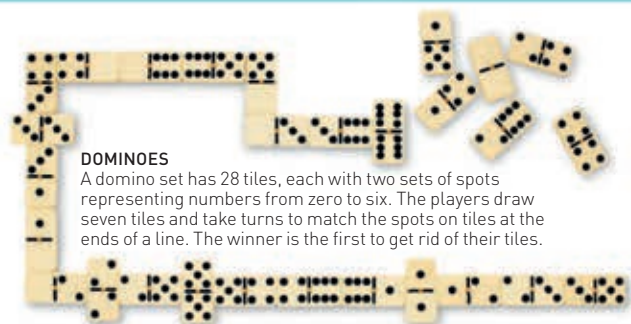


PICK-UP STICKS

The sticks are dropped in a heap and each player in turn tries to pull a stick from the pile without disturbing the rest. The player with the most sticks wins.

DOMINOES

A domino set has 28 tiles, each with two sets of spots representing numbers from zero to six. The players draw seven tiles and take turns to match the spots on tiles at the ends of a line. The winner is the first to get rid of their tiles.



SOLITAIRE

The aim of this game for one person is to clear the board by jumping marbles over each other to remove them. The game is complete when just one marble is left in the centre hole.



CARD GAMES

Easy to carry and used all over the world, packs of cards are the starting point for thousands of different games. Digital versions of many traditional games can also be played online.



CARDS FROM AROUND THE WORLD

European packs have 52 cards in four suits — hearts, clubs, diamonds, and spades. Other cards have pictures or shapes.

EUROPEAN CARDS